
Market Strategies for Dummies

A plain-language learner track
for reading charts with discipline

Practice first. Paper trade only.
Measure price behavior — do not invent intent.

Companion guide · Not financial advice

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LESSON 1

Start here

1.1 Welcome

This mini-book teaches you a **simple way to read charts** using the same ideas behind this research platform:

1. Figure out the big picture (going somewhere, or stuck in a range?)
2. Find an interesting price area
3. Wait for confirmation — don't guess from one fancy candle

You will practice on **paper / demo / dry-run only** until you and the builders agree otherwise.

1.2 How to use these lessons

- Read **one lesson**, then do the **Practice** box.
- Keep a journal (Lesson 11). That journal is gold for the developers.
- When a word is weird, peek at the Learner glossary.
- Curious about the “why” / architecture? That's the master guide — optional.

1.3 Time estimate

Pace	Calendar
Casual	~2 weeks (one lesson + practice every day or two)

Pace	Calendar
------	----------

Focused	~5–7 days
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Cohort	Follow the builder's schedule in Lesson 13
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1.4 Honesty up front

- Nothing here is financial advice.
- Past patterns do not guarantee future results.
- “Smart money” stories on the internet are **stories**. We measure price behavior.
- If a lesson and the platform disagree, **the platform rules win** for automated research.

LESSON 2

What you will learn (and what you won't)

2.1 You will learn

- How to read a candlestick without panic
- How to spot levels where price often reacts
- How to tell “trending” from “going nowhere”
- A **3-question habit** before every trade idea
- What a fair value gap (imbalance) looks like
- What a “sweep” is (wick beyond a level, then reclaim)
- A few chart patterns (including rising/falling wedges) as **hints**, not magic
- A checklist and a journal format builders can study

2.2 You will not learn (here)

- How to get rich quick
- How to override risk rules because “it feels right”
- Live order placement on this MVP stack (that’s gated and dry-run by design)
- Every ICT acronym on Twitter
- Footprint / order-flow vendor screens (advanced; see master guide later)

2.3 Mental model

Think of trading ideas like weather reports:

Bad habit	Better habit
"This candle means buy"	"Context + level + confirmation"
"Institutions did X"	"Price did X; here's the measurement"
"I'm always in a trade"	"Most of the time I wait"

2.4 Practice

Write three sentences in your notes:

1. Why you want to learn this
2. How much time you can practice per day
3. Your rule: "I only paper trade until ____"

LESSON 3

Safety, paper trading, and house rules

3.1 House rules (non-negotiable for this cohort)

1. **Paper / demo / dry-run only** unless a builder explicitly opens another mode in writing.
2. Never risk money you can't lose. Ever.
3. No "all in." Position size is small and boring on purpose.
4. If you're emotional, you stop. Flat is a position.
5. Screenshots + journal every session (builders need evidence, not vibes).

3.2 What "dry-run" means here

This project's research stack is built to **fail closed** on live trading. Treat that as a feature: you're learning to *think*, not to gamble through a half-finished robot.

3.3 Session hygiene

Before you open a chart:

- ☐ Sleep / food / calm enough to follow a checklist
- ☐ Timer set (e.g. 45–90 minutes max)
- ☐ Journal doc open
- ☐ One market (or a tiny watchlist), not twenty tabs

After:

- ☐ Mark wins/losses on *ideas*, not ego
- ☐ Note confusion points (those are product gold)

3.4 Practice

Create a folder or doc titled trading-journal-YYYY-MM. Paste this header:

Date:

Market:

Timeframe(s):

Session length:

Rule check (paper only?): Y/N

Mood 1–5:

LESSON 4

Candles in plain English

4.1 At a glance

A candlestick is a **finished time box**. It tells you where price started, where it ended, and how far it stretched while that box was forming. It is the alphabet of chart reading.

Figure 3.1. A visual reference for open, high, low, close, body, and wick anatomy.

4.2 Why candles matter

Before you can understand fair value gaps, sweeps, wedges, or trend, you need to become fluent in what one finished candle is saying. Most beginners skip this step and jump straight to pattern names. That creates a fake sense of skill. If you cannot calmly describe a single candle, you are not ready to trust a three-candle setup.

Candles matter because they answer three basic questions:

1. Where did price **open**?
2. Where did price **close**?
3. How far did price explore **above** and **below** that box before settling?

That is already enough to tell you whether the market looked decisive, hesitant, rejected, or quiet.

4.3 One candle = one time box

Each candle summarizes what happened during a chunk of time (1m, 5m, 1h, 1d, ...):

Part	Meaning	What a beginner should notice
Open	First price in the box	Where the story began
Close	Last price in the box	Who “won” the box
High	Highest price tagged	How far buyers pushed
Low	Lowest price tagged	How far sellers pushed
Body	Between open and close	Conviction / net progress
Wicks	The shadows beyond the body	Rejection, testing, or noise

If close is above open, buyers “won the box” (often colored green). If close is below open, sellers won (often red). Colors are cosmetic; **close vs open** is the fact.

4.4 How to read candle personality

Big body, small wicks

Usually means one side had control for most of the box. This does **not** automatically mean the next candle follows through, but it does mean the market was not indecisive during that period.

Tiny body, long wicks

Usually means argument, not clarity. Price traveled, but neither side kept control. This often happens inside messy areas where beginners overtrade.

Long lower wick

Price traded lower, but by the close buyers pushed it back up. This can become useful later near a level, but only if the larger context supports it.

Long upper wick

Mirror image: price traded higher, but sellers pushed it back down before the box closed.

4.5 What a candle does *not* tell you

- Who “institutions” were
- Whether the next candle will reverse
- Whether you should be all-in (never)
- Whether a setup is valid without context

A candle is a **summary**, not a prophecy.

4.6 Closed candles only

For learning with this project’s philosophy: wait until the candle **finishes**. Drawing conclusions on a half-formed candle is how people lie to themselves.

That rule matters because a candle can look amazing halfway through and pathetic by the close. Builders designed the platform around **closed-candle evidence** for exactly this reason: you want

observations that can be reproduced later.

4.7 Famous names (optional)

You'll hear "doji," "engulfing," "hammer." Treat names as nicknames. Nice for journaling; not a full strategy.

A good learner sentence is:

"This was a small-bodied candle with a long lower wick near support."

That is already better than:

"Hammer, must bounce."

4.8 Common beginner mistakes

- Falling in love with one candle before the box closes
- Treating every long wick like a reversal signal
- Ignoring where the candle formed
- Using candle names as automatic trade buttons

4.9 Practice

On any liquid chart (BTC, ETH, a major FX pair, etc.):

1. Pick the 15-minute chart.
2. Screenshot 20 closed candles.
3. Label 5 of them: "long wick up," "long wick down," "big body," "tiny body."

4. Write one sentence: “Most of these boxes look like ____ (trend / chop / mixed).”
5. For two candles, explain them without using any pattern nickname.

4.10 Builder note

When learners describe candles in plain language, builders can compare those descriptions to future detector outputs. That creates cleaner supervision than vague labels like “looks bullish.”

LESSON 5

Support, resistance, and “levels”

5.1 At a glance

A **level** is a price area where the market previously reacted strongly enough that you should care when price comes back.

Figure 4.1. Pattern sheets often mark support and resistance lines explicitly. Use them as visual training wheels, not as magic lines.

5.2 Levels are places price has “cared about”

A **level** is a price area where the market previously turned, paused, rejected, or repeatedly tagged.

- **Support** — buyers showed up enough that price bounced up (in the past)
- **Resistance** — sellers showed up enough that price bounced down (in the past)

Past $\neq$ future. Levels are **candidates**, not guarantees.

5.3 Why levels matter

Without levels, every candle looks equally important. That is the beginner trap.

The real job is not “find any candle that looks dramatic.” The real job is:

1. Find a place that matters.

2. Wait for price to revisit it.
3. Judge what price does **there**.

A weak-looking candle at a very important level can matter more than a huge candle in the middle of nowhere.

5.4 How to mark levels (beginner method)

1. Zoom out (higher timeframe first — e.g. 1h or 4h).
2. Mark obvious swing highs and swing lows (clear turning points).
3. Prefer **zones** (a small band) over a single pixel-perfect line.
4. Zoom in only after the big map exists.

A textbook beginner rule:

If you need to squint, argue with yourself, or keep moving the line three pixels, the level is probably not obvious enough yet.

5.5 Equal highs / equal lows

When several highs line up, that cluster often matters later. You do not need the advanced liquidity vocabulary yet. Journal it as:

- “equal highs around X”
- “equal lows around Y”

That wording is already useful to both learners and builders.

5.6 Zones are better than sniper lines

Beginners love exact numbers because exactness feels smart. Markets are messier than that.

A better mindset:

- Use a **band** or **zone**
- Expect slight overshoots
- Care about the **close** and reaction, not just the first touch

This is one reason the later sweep lesson matters so much.

5.7 What we measure later (preview)

The research platform prefers **confirmed pivots** and clear events like:

- touch
- wick through and reclaim (**sweep**)
- close beyond (acceptance / break)

You can start by eye; builders will compare your eye to the machine.

5.8 Common beginner mistakes

- Marking ten levels on one screen
- Drawing lines on every tiny wiggle
- Using the lowest timeframe first
- Treating a level break and a level sweep like the same thing

5.9 Practice

Mark 3 support zones and 3 resistance zones on one market.

For each, write:

- Timeframe you used
- Why you marked it (prior swing? multiple touches?)
- What would make you say “this level failed” (e.g. strong close through)
- Whether the zone feels **major** or **minor**

5.10 Builder note

If learners consistently mark different zones than the system’s pivot map, that is not just a user problem. It may reveal a product-language mismatch, missing aggregation logic, or poor UI presentation of level confidence.

LESSON 6

Trend vs chop (is the market going somewhere?)

6.1 At a glance

Most bad trades come from one mistake: trying to trade a trending idea in a choppy market, or a reversal idea in a strong trend.

Figure 5.1. A cheat-sheet style reminder that different environments call for different tactics. You do not need every tactic yet; you do need to recognize the environment.

6.2 Two big weather systems

Mode	Looks like	Beginner bias
Trend / discovery	Higher highs & higher lows (up) or lower highs & lower lows (down)	Prefer <i>with</i> -trend ideas
Chop / balance	Price rotates between a high and a low; messy middle	Prefer <i>waiting</i> or mean-reversion <i>practice</i> only

You don't need perfect labels. You need a **default stance**.

6.3 Why this matters before entries

Imagine trying to surf in a swimming pool. The problem is not your surfboard. The problem is the environment.

That is what context does for trading:

- In a trend, your default bias is continuation.
- In chop, your default bias is caution.
- In uncertainty, your default bias is **flat**.

That last one saves beginners more money than any pattern ever will.

6.4 Simple tests (no indicators required)

1. Are swing lows rising or falling over the last several swings?
2. Is price making progress away from a range, or bouncing inside one?
3. If you blur your eyes, is it a diagonal staircase or a rectangle?

6.5 Optional helpers (later)

Builders may show EMA alignment on higher timeframes (“HTF bias”). For now, your eye + swings are enough.

Do not use indicators as a replacement for seeing the chart. Use them later as a **double-check** on what you already think the chart is saying.

6.6 Why this comes before entries

Trading breakouts in a quiet rectangle is how accounts shrink.

Fading a strong trend because “it went too far” is how accounts shrink faster.

Context first. Always.

6.7 A beginner-friendly decision tree

Can I call this trend up, trend down, or range?

- | No → stand down, observe only
- | Trend up → look for pullbacks / bullish reclaims at levels
- | Trend down → look for rallies / bearish rejections at levels
- | Range → beginner mode = reduce aggression, wait for very

6.8 Common beginner mistakes

- Calling every noisy chart a trend
- Switching bias every three candles
- Taking both long and short ideas in the same unclear area
- Confusing “volatile” with “trending”

6.9 Practice

On your chart, write at the top:

HTF stance today: TREND UP / TREND DOWN / CHOP / UNSURE

Evidence:

Force yourself to pick one. “Unsure” means **no new trade ideas** — only observation journal.

Then go back 20 sessions and score yourself:

- How often was “unsure” actually the correct answer?
- How often did your best ideas come when context was obvious?

6.10 Builder note

This lesson is where human journals can teach the system the most. “Trend / chop / unsure” labels are a natural bridge into future regime-classification capabilities.

LESSON 7

The three questions before every idea

7.1 At a glance

This is the backbone of the whole learner track.

Figure 6.1. A concept-heavy screenshot from the note corpus. Use it as a reminder that one idea is usually a stack of clues, not one magical signal.

7.2 The simple version

Every trade idea must answer three questions **in order**:

1. **Context** — What is the market doing broadly?
2. **Location** — Where is interesting?
3. **Confirmation** — Is something actually defending that idea now?

If any one of those is missing, you do not have a finished idea. You have a hunch.

7.3 Ask in order — do not skip

1) Context — What's the market doing broadly?

Trending up, trending down, or chopping?

If you can't answer, **stop**. No entry fantasy.

Context is the job of Lesson 5. You are deciding whether your idea is flowing *with* the bigger map or fighting it.

2) Location — Where is interesting?

Which level / zone matters *given* that context?

Examples:

- Sweep of prior lows in an uptrend context
- Edge of a range in chop (advanced — usually skip as a beginner)
- A gap / imbalance left after a fast move (next lesson)

Location keeps you from taking trades in the middle of nowhere.

3) Confirmation — Is something actually defending that idea *now*?

Not “I think it will.” Something you can point to:

- A closed candle reclaiming a level after a wick through
- A clear rejection after tagging your zone
- (Later) automated confluence scores from the platform

Confirmation is where patience lives.

7.4 Why this framework is so powerful

It protects you from three common beginner diseases:

Disease	Which question cures it
Random impulse entries	Context
Mid-chart boredom trades	Location
Jumping in before proof	Confirmation

7.5 Pocket card

1 CONTEXT: trend up / trend down / chop / unsure
2 LOCATION: level or zone = _____ @ _____
3 CONFIRM: what closed-candle proof do I have?
IF any blank → NO TRADE

7.6 A full example

Imagine price is broadly trending up.

- **Context:** market still making higher lows
- **Location:** price returns to an old support zone and tags an FVG box
- **Confirmation:** a candle wicks below the zone but closes back above it

That is a complete idea. Whether it wins or loses is a different question. But it is **structured**.

7.7 Why builders love this

If every journal row answers these three, they can compare humans vs detectors — and improve the insight tools without guessing what you meant.

7.8 Practice

For the next 10 “almost trades” you notice, fill the pocket card even if you don’t take them. Count how many fail question 1 or 3.

Then review the set and ask:

- Which question do I skip most often?

- Do I tend to invent confirmation because I am bored?
- Am I better at context or at location?

LESSON 8

Fair value gaps without the mystique

8.1 At a glance

A fair value gap is a **fast-move scar**. Price moved through an area so quickly that traders later watch that area when price comes back.

Figure 7.1. Screenshot notes tying imbalance, FVG, order-block ideas, and filters together. For beginners, the key takeaway is simpler: a gap is a location candidate, not an auto-entry.

8.2 Plain definition

A **fair value gap (FVG)** / imbalance is a place where price moved so fast that candles didn't fully "overlap" in the usual way — leaving a visible gap in the pattern of highs and lows.

Think: the market ran through a hallway without stopping to chat.

8.3 Why people care about gaps

Fast moves often leave behind unfinished business. When price revisits that area later, traders watch to see whether the zone acts like:

- a bounce area
- a hesitation area
- a slice-through area

That is why an FVG belongs under **Location** in the three-question model.

8.4 What it is good for

Location. Gaps left after a strong move often get revisited later. That revisit is a *candidate* area — not a guaranteed bounce.

8.5 What it is not

- Proof of a conspiracy
- A reason to ignore context
- A reason to skip confirmation
- A promise that price must fill every box immediately

8.6 Beginner recognition drill

On a 5m or 15m chart after a sharp burst:

1. Find three consecutive candles where the middle move left a clear separation between the first and third candle's ranges.
2. Draw a box over that separation.
3. Wait. Journal whether price returned to the box later.

You don't need the exact platform formula yet. Builders will show you the precise indexing when you're ready (master: FVG chapter).

8.7 Tie to the three questions

Step	FVG role
Context	Prefer gaps that agree with the larger direction
Location	The gap box <i>is</i> a location candidate
Confirm	Wait for a closed reaction at/into the box

8.8 What a good beginner sentence sounds like

“In an uptrend, price returned to a prior bullish gap near support. I did not enter until a closed candle reacted there.”

That is much better than:

“Gap touched, buy now.”

8.9 Common beginner mistakes

- Marking every tiny visual separation as an FVG
- Forcing a trade just because price touched the box
- Ignoring whether the larger trend agrees
- Confusing “interesting” with “actionable”

8.10 Practice

Screenshot 3 historical FVGs (by eye). For each:

- Context at the time
- Did price return?
- What happened on the first return (bounce, slice through,

chop)?

- Was your first reaction too early?

8.11 Builder note

Learner-marked FVGs are valuable comparison data against deterministic imbalance. fvg geometry. Repeated mismatch can reveal either poor education or a detector-definition gap.

LESSON 9

Sweeps: the wick that failed

9.1 At a glance

A sweep is one of the cleanest beginner concepts in this project: price **goes beyond** a level, but by the close that break **fails**.

Figure 8.1. Notes connecting liquidity sweeps, change of character, inducement, and long-entry thinking. Beginners only need the simplest layer here: wick beyond, close back inside.

9.2 Plain definition

A **sweep** (in this project's careful sense) is when price:

1. Pokes **beyond** a known level with a wick, **and**
2. **Closes back inside** — the break didn't stick.

If price **closes beyond** the level, that is often **acceptance / continuation**, not a sweep.

This distinction matters. Internet slang ("stop hunt") is optional flavor; the measurement is what we keep.

9.3 Why beginners should care

Sweeps near obvious highs/lows are common "trap then reverse" stories. Sometimes they're real opportunities; sometimes they're noise. Your job is to combine them with **context**.

Example (long idea sketch):

- Context: uptrend / bullish bias
- Location: prior lows or equal lows
- Confirm: wick under lows, close back above

9.4 The emotional trick of a sweep

A sweep feels dramatic because the wick looks like the break already happened. That is why beginners panic and click too early.

The platform's discipline is smarter:

- **Wick beyond + close inside** = failed break / sweep
- **Close beyond** = acceptance / continuation

That one distinction can save months of confusion.

9.5 Journal language (copy this)

Sweep? Y/N

Level:

Wick beyond? Y/N

Close back inside? Y/N

If close beyond instead: label ACCEPTANCE (not sweep)

9.6 Common beginner mistakes

- Calling every stop-looking wick a sweep
- Ignoring the close
- Looking for sweeps in random places instead of obvious levels
- Trading every sweep even when context is terrible

9.7 Practice

Find 5 historical examples:

- 3 true sweeps (wick beyond + close inside)
- 2 acceptances (close beyond)

Write how you felt emotionally looking at the wick — then note how the **close** changed the story.

Then add one extra note:

- Did the sweep happen at a level you had already marked, or did you invent the level afterward?

9.8 Builder note

This lesson is perfect for structured comparison against the system's sweep rule. When learners and code disagree, you can usually explain it with one of three causes: wrong level, premature read, or close/acceptance confusion.

LESSON 10

Patterns you'll actually see (wedges, flags, triangles)

10.1 At a glance

Patterns are **shape nicknames**. They help you describe structure quickly, but they do not replace context or confirmation.

Figure 9.1. One of the screenshot reference sheets in the graph corpus. The learner goal is not to memorize every shape. The learner goal is to stop over-trusting shapes.

10.2 Patterns are cartoons of structure

A chart pattern is a nickname for a shape made of swings. Useful for **communication**. Dangerous as a standalone trigger.

This project's knowledge graph includes many patterns from cheat sheets — including **rising wedge** and **falling wedge**.

10.3 A tiny pattern kit

Pattern	Rough look	Beginner use
Flag / pennant	Sharp move, then tight pause	Hint of continuation <i>if</i> context agrees

Pattern	Rough look	Beginner use
Ascending triangle	Flat top, rising lows	Compression into resistance — wait for close + confirm
Descending triangle	Flat bottom, falling highs	Mirror of above
Rising wedge	Both lines rise, narrowing	Often a “careful / exhaustion?” hint — not auto-short
Falling wedge	Both lines fall, narrowing	Often a “compression in a decline” hint — not auto-long
Double top / bottom	Two similar highs/lows	Level cluster story

10.4 The rule that saves accounts

*Pattern = **optional tag** on question 2 (location/structure).*

It never replaces questions 1 and 3.

If you only remember one sentence from this lesson, remember that.

10.5 Why wedges get people in trouble

Wedges feel smart because the lines look clean.

But a wedge by itself does not tell you:

- whether the bigger chart is trending or chopping
- whether the wedge is forming at a meaningful level

- whether the breakout/reversal actually confirmed on a close

That is why wedges are in this course as **visual aids**, not as holy grails.

10.6 How to use a pattern responsibly

1. Spot the shape.
2. Treat it as a **note**, not a signal.
3. Force the three questions anyway.
4. If the pattern and the context disagree, trust context more.

10.7 Common beginner mistakes

- Seeing patterns everywhere
- Drawing trendlines after the move already happened
- Using the pattern name as the trade thesis
- Ignoring nearby support/resistance or gaps

10.8 Practice

Find one rising wedge and one falling wedge on historical charts.

For each, force the three questions. Did the “classic” outcome happen? Journal honestly either way — failed patterns teach builders about false positives.

Then do the same for one triangle or flag.

10.9 Builder note

Patterns are excellent “soft-label” material for explanation layers, but weak standalone authority. Learner journals can help distinguish educational value from detector value.

LESSON 11

Your one-page trade checklist

11.1 At a glance

This is the single page that turns all the prior lessons into a repeatable habit.

Figure 10.1. Use visual cheat sheets as reminders, but force every idea through the written checklist below.

Print this or pin it next to your screen. If a box is empty, you do nothing.

11.2 Why checklists work

Beginners do not usually lose because they are stupid. They lose because they improvise under emotion.

A checklist gives you a stable script when your brain wants action. It also gives builders structured data they can compare with platform decisions.

11.3 Before the session

- ☐ Paper / demo / dry-run only
- ☐ Timer set
- ☐ Journal open
- ☐ One market (or tiny list)

11.4 For every idea

1) Context

- ☐ Trend up / trend down / chop / unsure (circle one)
- ☐ Evidence in one line: _____
- ☐ If unsure → **STOP**

2) Location

- ☐ Level / zone marked
- ☐ Why this level (swing / equals / FVG box / other): _____
- ☐ Optional pattern tag: _____ (or “none”)

3) Confirmation

- ☐ Closed candle proof (sweep reclaim / rejection / other):

- ☐ Invalidation level (where the idea is wrong): _____
- ☐ Target idea (even on paper): _____

Risk (paper)

- ☐ Planned size is small and boring
- ☐ I am not “making it back” from a prior loss
- ☐ Mood $\geq$ OK (if not, flat)

11.5 After the idea resolves

- ☐ Screenshot entry theory + outcome
- ☐ Grade process (A/B/C), not money
- ☐ One sentence: what I'd teach a friend

11.6 Process grades

Grade	Meaning
A	Followed checklist; good or bad outcome doesn't matter
B	Minor skip (e.g. vague invalidation)
C	Broke house rules or skipped a question

Builders care more about **A-process** frequency than lucky PnL.

11.7 How to use it like a textbook exercise

For one week:

- Fill the checklist for **every** idea
- Do not hide skipped trades
- Highlight the line you broke on any C-grade idea

At the end of the week, count:

- How many ideas died at context
- How many died at location

- How many died at confirmation
- How many you still took anyway

That count tells you where your discipline leaks.

LESSON 12

How to journal so builders can learn from you

You are not only learning to trade. You are generating **observation data** for the insight system (friction, confusion, near-misses, language mismatches). That is the guinea-pig loop — said with respect.

12.1 Minimum viable journal entry

Copy for each idea (taken or skipped):

ID: (date-market-#)

Market:

TF_context:

TF_entry:

Stance: trend_up | trend_down | chop | unsure

Location: (level description)

Confirm: (closed-candle proof or "none")

Pattern_tag: (optional)

Action: taken | skipped

Skip_reason: (if skipped)

Invalidation:

Outcome: win | loss | BE | n/a

Process: A | B | C

Confusion: (what felt unclear – be specific)

Screenshot: (link/filename)

Builder_flag:(optional) "detector_disagreed" | "ui_confusing" | "t

12.2 What builders will mine

Your field	Why it matters
Stance + skip_reason	False opportunity rate / regime confusion
Confirm empty but Action taken	Protocol violations (product + coaching)
Confusion	Docs UX, glossary gaps, GUI labels
Builder_flag	Direct friction events for the capability loop
Screenshots	Ground truth vs automated geometry

12.3 Cadence

- During learning: **every session**
- After week 1: weekly 10-minute retro with a builder (or solo summary)

12.4 Privacy

Don't put exchange passwords, API keys, or personal financial account numbers in journals. Market screenshots and process notes only.

12.5 Practice

Submit (or save) **five** complete entries using the template — including skipped ideas.

LESSON 13

Mistakes everyone makes

13.1 The greatest hits

Mistake	Fix
Trading while “unsure” on context	Flat. Observe only.
Entering on a wick before the candle closes	Wait for close
Calling every wick a sweep	Require close back inside
Pattern-only entries	Pattern is a tag, not a plan
Moving invalidation because feelings	Invalidation is sacred on paper too
Revenge trade after a loss	Timer ends the session
Twelve markets at once	One market mastery
Treating Twitter intent stories as facts	Measure price; journal behavior
Skipping the journal on losing days	Especially journal those days
Asking the bot for live fire too early	Dry-run / paper until builders say otherwise

13.2 When you're stuck

Re-read Lesson 6 and run five **skipped** ideas on purpose. Skipping well is a skill.

13.3 Optional deep links (when ready)

- Master protocol: Unified reading protocol
- Order flow: Auction and order flow
- Confluence law: Six-component model

LESSON 14

For builders — running learner cohorts

This lesson is for developers who finished the master guide / thesis and want **human guinea pigs** (learners) generating structured feedback.

14.1 Cohort goal

Not “prove the strategy prints money.”

Prove that:

- 1. Learners can apply Context → Location → Confirm
- 2. Journals are structured enough to mine friction
- 3. Insight UX / detectors disagree with humans in *interesting*, fixable ways
- 4. Authority boundaries (paper/dry-run) hold under social pressure

14.2 Suggested 10-day cohort plan

Day	Learner focus	Builder focus
0	Safety + journal setup	Collect baseline survey (experience, time, markets)

Day	Learner focus	Builder focus
1-2	Candles + levels	Spot vocabulary mismatches
3	Trend vs chop	Tag regime confusion events
4-5	Three questions drills	Measure skip quality
6	FVG by eye	Compare to imbalance. fvg geometry later
7	Sweeps vs acceptance	Compare to sweep detector rules
8	Patterns as tags only	False-positive pattern reliance
9	Full checklist live session	Shadow: platform alerts vs human ideas
10	Retro	Promote friction → capability candidates (thesis Ch.14)

14.3 Instrumentation (minimum)

- Shared journal sheet (Lesson 11 template)
- Screenshot folder convention: cohort/<id>/<date>/
- Weekly export: counts of Process A/B/C, skip reasons, builder_flags

- Optional: map flags → friction event types in telemetry later

14.4 Ethics & consent

- Learners know they are in a research/practice cohort
- No pressure to fund live accounts
- No shaming losing paper trades
- Clear “stop” button: leave cohort anytime

14.5 What “success” looks like for CNIS

Signal	Healthy	Unhealthy
Process A rate	Rising	PnL obsession, process falling
Confusion notes	Specific, actionable	Empty journals
Detector disagreement	Documented, reproducible	Hand-wavy “bot is wrong”
Authority	Still paper/dry-run	Social push to go live early

14.6 Facilitator checklist

- ☐ Master guide read (esp. Ch.2 authority, Ch.13 protocol, Ch.14 hypothesis)
- ☐ Cohort brief sent (safety rules)
- ☐ Journal template shared

- ☐ Office hours scheduled
- ☐ Explicit non-goals: no live execution, no guarantee of edge

14.7 Handoff back to product

Each cohort should produce a short memo:

1. Top 5 learner frictions
2. Top 5 vocabulary mismatches (notes vs UI vs detectors)
3. 3 capability candidates (with owners)
4. What will **not** change (mandatory gates, dry-run)

That memo is the slow adaptation loop feeding the capability registry — humans included.

Learner glossary

Word	Simple meaning
Candle	Summary of open/high/low/close for a time box
Closed candle	Finished time box — safe to judge
Level / zone	Price area that previously mattered
Support	Area that bounced price up before
Resistance	Area that bounced price down before
Trend	Swings progressing up or down
Chop / range	Price rotating without clear progress
Context	Big-picture stance (question 1)
Location	Where your idea lives (question 2)
Confirmation	Closed-candle proof (question 3)
FVG / imbalance	Fast-move “gap” area that may be revisited

Word	Simple meaning
Sweep	Wick beyond a level + close back inside
Acceptance	Close beyond a level (break that sticks)
Invalidation	Price where your idea is wrong
Wedge / flag / triangle	Shape nicknames — tags, not full strategies
Paper / dry-run	Practice without real live risk on this stack
Process grade	Did you follow the checklist? (A/B/C)

Full technical glossary: ../../guide/99-glossary.md

Master book TOC: ../README.md

14.8 Mini table of contents

#	Lesson
0	Start here
1	What you will learn
2	Safety
3	Candles
4	Levels
5	Trend vs chop
6	Three questions
7	FVGs

#	Lesson
8	Sweeps
9	Patterns
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